

Amendment No. 1 to SB0422

Bailey
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 422

House Bill No. 406*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 56, Chapter 7, Part 23, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) As used in this section:

(1) "Covered person" means a person on whose behalf a health insurer is obligated to pay benefits or provide services pursuant to a health benefit plan;

(2) "Health benefit plan" means health insurance coverage, as defined in § 56-7-109;

(3) "Health insurer" means a health insurance entity, as defined in § 56-7-109; and

(4) "Healthcare provider" means a person who is licensed, certified, authorized, or permitted by the laws of this state to administer health care in the ordinary course of business or practice of a profession.

(b)

(1) A health insurer shall include in a health benefit plan that provides coverage for hospital, medical, or surgical expenses; is offered, issued, amended, or renewed in this state on or after January 1, 2027; and pays benefits or provides services for a covered person, coverage for prosthetic and custom orthotic devices in a manner that:

(A) Equals or exceeds the levels of coverage for such devices under the federal medicare program; and

(B) Is no more restrictive than coverage for other medical devices provided under the health benefit plan.

(2) Coverage for prosthetic or custom orthotic devices required by subdivision (b)(1) must include:

(A) A prosthetic or custom orthotic device determined by the covered person's healthcare provider to be the most appropriate model that adequately meets the medical needs of the covered person for purposes of completing activities of daily living or essential job-related activities;

(B) For a covered person who is not more than seventeen (17) years of age, a prosthetic or custom orthotic device determined by the covered person's healthcare provider to be the most appropriate model that meets the medical needs of the covered person for purposes of performing physical activities, including, but not limited to, running, cycling, swimming, and strength training, or to maximize the covered person's whole-body health and lower or upper limb function;

(C) All materials and components necessary to use the prosthetic or custom orthotic device;

(D) Instruction to the enrollee on using the prosthetic or custom orthotic device; and

(E) Repair or replacement of the prosthetic or custom orthotic device.

(c) A health insurer that issues a health benefit plan that is subject to subsection (b) shall:

(1) Consider coverage benefits for prosthetic and custom orthotic devices as habilitative or rehabilitative benefits for purposes of any state or federal requirement for coverage of essential health benefits;

(2) When performing a utilization review for a request for coverage of a prosthetic or custom orthotic device, apply the most recent version of evidence-based treatment and fit criteria as recognized by relevant clinical specialists or relevant clinical specialist organizations, which the commissioner may identify by rules promulgated in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5;

(3) Render a utilization review determination in a nondiscriminatory manner and shall not deny coverage for a prosthetic or custom orthotic device solely on the basis of a covered person's actual or perceived disability;

(4) Include a prosthetic or custom orthotic device in a covered person's benefits if the treating healthcare provider determines that the prosthetic or custom orthotic device is medically necessary for the purpose of:

(A) Completing activities of daily living or essential job-related activities;

(B) Performing physical activities, including running, cycling, swimming, and strength training; or

(C) Maximizing the covered person's whole-body health and lower or upper limb function;

(5) Not deny coverage of a prosthetic or custom orthotic device for an individual with limb loss or absence that would otherwise be covered for a person without a disability who is seeking medical or surgical intervention to restore or maintain the ability to perform the same physical activity;

(6) Include language describing a covered person's rights pursuant to subdivisions (c)(3) and (4) in its correspondence with the covered person regarding coverage benefits or a denial of coverage;

(7) Not impose cost-sharing requirements on prosthetic or custom orthotic devices that are more restrictive than cost-sharing requirements applicable to other benefits under the plan;

(8) Ensure access to medically necessary clinical care and to prosthetic and custom orthotic devices and technology from not less than two (2) distinct prosthetic and custom orthotic device providers in the health benefit plan's provider network in this state, or, if medically necessary covered prosthetic and custom orthotic devices are not available from an in-network provider, provide a process by which the covered person is referred to an out-of-network provider and fully reimburse the out-of-network provider at a mutually agreed upon rate less any cost-sharing requirement as determined on an in-network basis; and

(9) For a covered prosthetic or custom orthotic device, provide reimbursement for the replacement of the prosthetic or custom orthotic device or for any part of such devices, without regard to continuous use or useful lifetime restrictions, if an ordering healthcare provider determines that the provision of a replacement device, or a replacement part of such device, is necessary because:

(A) Of a change in the physiological condition of the covered person;

(B) Of an irreparable change in the condition of the device or a part of the device; or

(C) The condition of the device or a part of the device requires repair, and the cost of such repair would be more than sixty percent (60%) of the cost of a replacement device or part.

(d) A health insurer may require confirmation from a prescribing healthcare provider if a prosthetic or custom orthotic device or part being replaced pursuant to subdivision (c)(9) is less than three (3) years of age.

(e) A violation of this section may subject the health insurer to any of the sanctions described in § 56-2-305.

(f) Notwithstanding subsections (b)-(e), the TennCare program or a successor medicaid program provided for in title 71, chapter 5, and the CoverKids program or a successor program provided for in title 71, chapter 3, part 11, are only required to cover prosthetic and custom orthotic devices for children under twenty-one (21) years of age and shall only reimburse for such devices when determined to be medically necessary pursuant to § 71-5-144.

SECTION 2. The commissioner of commerce and insurance may promulgate rules to effectuate this act. The rules must be promulgated in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5.

SECTION 3. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.